

Bombard Beats Tech—

Surprise! Miners Hit .301 Average

By MIKE PEMBERTON

Andy Cohen's U.T. El Paso Miner baseballers just finished knocking off their fifth straight game with southpaws and are looking forward to their sixth in a row, but with a slight change in tactics.

Tomorrow when the mound strong Miners hit the field against the New Mexico State Aggies at Dudley Field Cohen will use a right hander. "I" either go with Ron Peterson or Larry Smith and doing the work behind the plate will be Ron Hix," Cohen said.

The Aggies are led by second basemen Lloyd Bates at the plate with a .428 average and Chuck Bowden with a .346 mark. The team as whole is hitting .250 and is 1-16 for the year.

PREDICTIONSS had it at the start of the season the Miners weren't a hitting ball club and if they were to win they would have to do something at the plate. They have done just that in the first seven games of the season.

As a team they are batting .301 and five starting players are batting over the .300 mark. John Miller is at the top of squad with a .450 mark

followed by Mike Ward with a .391 average. Behind Miller and Ward are Ron Hix at .353, Juan Sandoval with .346 and Danny Blanco with a .305.

AS EXPECTED their pitching is the top department. As a team they have given up only 1.96 earned runs per game and have avergaed 5.67 earned runs a game.

Saturday the Miners met Texas Tech in the finale of a three game series and made it a sweep, with their second 5-2 win over the Red Raiders at Dudley Field.

The Miners gave up only six runs to an always strong hitting Tech team, but none of these were earned.

Cohen said, "Marc Bombard was the difference. His fast ball was working real well and he had good control. Even if a pitcher has good stuff he must have control to win and Bombard did."

The Miners rallied in the bottom of fourth inning behind some clutch hitting and an error. Joe Donohue added two runs to the Miners column with two run scoring single.

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Pat McKean, Mike Muschalick (3)
John Pierce (7) and Max Martin; Marc Bombard and Ron Hix.